

The War of Four

A Mage Knight Scenario by Jesse Stern

Basic Info

Players: 1-6

Type: Very Competitive or Cooperative

Length: No Limit (but keep track of round number, as this is used for the retreat penalty outlined in the "Defense from Volkare" section).

Purpose: A long scenario that is primarily a combination between the scenarios "Volkare's Quest" and "Life and Death." This scenario is for people looking for an epic scenario combining the rules of both enemy factions and their territory with an epic final series of battles with Volkare. Players also have the opportunity to take control of the enemy factions and use their minions to help fight Volkare and hinder foes.

Flavor Text

As the Atlantean Empire tries to survive, caught between the war of the Elementalists and Dark Crusaders, Volkare returns from far off lands with an army in tow. The Atlanteans know naught whether Volkare intends to be their savior or a new tyrant. They fear the horde of creatures he brings with him to the land, but they will need to wait to find out their fate until after Volkare's march towards the portal. The Council of The Void is all that can stop him now, but with the destruction of the portal, the world will be his.

Though seemingly unstoppable, The Council finds hope in two key pieces of intelligence. The first is that one who seizes control of an Avatar of Tesla's heart will command the loyalty of the faction that follows it. They would then be able to insert agents into Volkare's army to strengthen it against foes and to turn on his followers upon your arrival. Additionally, the cities nearest the portal have ancient magical wards to protect the portal. Now, having learned how to activate them, control of the cities can prevent Volkare's continued progress until he can destroy the barrier's source in the city.

The Council sends for its Mage Knights to stop him, with promises of even greater power upon Volkare's demise at their hand (or hands if cooperative). Will you find friends among your peers, dominate the armies of the two other great powers of the land, or simply stride forth alone and cut Volkare down? Will anything you do really be able to stop Volkare from reaching his goal? Well, as a Mage Knight, I suppose that is up to you...

Objective

The player who defeats Volkare wins the scenario (if cooperative, all players win when Volkare is defeated). If Volkare moves on to the space with the Portal (the starting hex for players), all players lose.

Tiles

Always set up as pictured below. Randomize three stacks of tiles one each for, countryside, city, and non-city core tiles. Tiles with white crystals are always cities, tiles with green crystals are exactly one non-city core tile and one city tile (used for Elementalist Hidden Valley), and tiles with red crystals are exactly one non-city core tile and one city tile (used for Dark Crusaders Necropolis). Which of the two tiles with green (or red) crystal on them is a non-city core tile and which is a city tile should be randomly determined. Lastly, reveal the 3 countryside tiles adjacent to the start tile.



General Location Rules Changes

Graveyards/Necropolis: Graveyards now also remove wounds as if they were magical glades.

Cities: Cities are no longer safe spaces in competitive play. Multiple players may still be in a city without fighting, but anytime a player ends their movement in a city with at least one other player they may select a player they wish to fight. They fight this player using normal PvP rules except that if no retreat is forced, both players end their turn in the city.

Volkare Setup and Movement

Set up as in Volkare's Quest scenario. If the game is competitive, leave the four competitive spells in the spell deck and proxy for these four cards in Volkare's deck (this can be done using the cards of an unplayed character or some other means).  Do not use faction enemy tokens in Volkare's army during set-up. When Volkare is on a tile adjacent to the start tile and moves, he moves only directly towards the portal following the movement on the card for as many hexes as possible (and choosing uniformly at random from hexes strictly closer to the portal otherwise). If he lands on an *unconquered city* (i.e. One still defended by enemy tokens or an unrevealed city tile), he lands on the space and does not affect the city. If he reaches the portal, all players lose. If he lands on a *conquered city*, the city is *destroyed* unless at least one player is in the city and they successfully repel the attack (see **Defense from Volkare** below). When a city is *destroyed*, the city's model is removed from the board and the space it occupied now counts as an empty space of the terrain type depicted under the city on the tile. Once at least one city is *conquered*, Volkare now moves in the directions indicated by Volkare's Return, and moves directly towards the first conquered city, followed by the 2nd conquered city (if applicable), followed by moving directly towards the portal as indicated in Volkare's Quest. Note that, if the second city is conquered after the first city is destroyed, Volkare still follows the priority order outlined prior, heading toward the 2nd city followed by the portal. If Volkare's deck runs out, he moves two hexes towards the portal along the shortest route (or to undestroyed conquered cities as described prior if applicable). When moving towards the portal or a captured city by the shortest route, if Volkare ever has two possible shortest routes, each of his moves are decided uniformly at random from among the valid options.

Setup and Rules for Factions With an Avatar

Factions specific units are separated at the beginning of the game. *North* and *South* are defined as in the Life and Death scenario from Shades of Tezla. We call the tiles bordering the edge of the board (except the ones adjacent to the starting tile) the *Far North/Far South* (these still count as being in the north/south). When a North/South tile is revealed, roll for each rampaging monster and draw a monster of the appropriate color from the non-faction monster pile, or based upon the following criteria depending on the tile location and die roll:

- If on a *North* tile and black or red is rolled, draw instead from the Dark Crusader's monster pile.
- If on a *Far North* tile and black, red, white, or gold is rolled, draw instead from the Dark Crusader's monster pile.
- If on a *South* tile and gold or green is rolled, draw instead from the Elementalist's monster pile.
- If on a *Far South* tile and gold, green, blue, or black is rolled, draw instead from the Elementalist's monster pile.

When a magical glade is revealed in the *North* on a countryside tile, replace it with a graveyard and add a *Green* and *Brown* Dark Crusader face up that can be challenged like at a ruin. Magical glades are treated similarly in the *South* countryside tiles except that the *Green* and *Brown* monsters are drawn from the Elementalist's monster pile and no graveyard is placed. For a magical glade revealed on a core tile (including city tiles) do the same as you would do for a countryside tile, but use a *Brown* and *Red* enemy token from the appropriate faction.

As long as these original enemy tokens are on a magical glade or graveyard, the space is considered *occupied*. *Liberating* an occupied magical glade or graveyard works just as in the Life and Death scenario rules with different rewards upon liberation. On a countryside tile, the person to defeat the last enemy token on an occupied magical glade or graveyard liberates it and gains a Spell and two crystals of any combination of colors (in the *North*) or an Artifact (in the *South*). On a core or city tile, a player instead gains an Artifact, a Spell and an Advanced Action. Players get +1 reputation for liberating a magical glade or graveyard on a countryside tile and +2 reputation for liberating a magical glade or graveyard on a core tile (including city tiles).

Faction stronghold tiles always use their faction's enemy tokens for supporting monsters depicted on their dial. Large Faction Leader Tokens work as described in the rules and are fought at the Hidden Valley and Graveyard as described in the Life and Death scenario. The Hidden Valley and Necropolis work as in the Life and Death Scenario, though note the changed rules for Graveyards apply to the Necropolis as well.

Becoming a Faction Leader and Followers

When an avatar and all enemy tokens it came with are defeated, the player with the most shields (ties broken by shield at the highest level) gains the avatar's token face down as a *Faction Leader token* and becomes the corresponding faction's *Faction Leader*. All shields from the avatar are moved to the city card of the city under the faction's stronghold. The Faction Leader may interact at the site as if it were the underlying city. All enemy tokens of the Faction Leader's faction that remain on the map (i.e. Elementalists or Dark Crusaders) are now referred to as their *followers*. A player ignores all of their followers for the purpose of movement (this includes not provoking them) and cannot fight their own followers (in cooperative play, all players ignore the followers of any player as if they were the Faction Leader of those factions). For the purpose of other player's movement, followers are considered rampaging for the purposes of being provoked (unless they are already ambushing, see below). Players who defeat another player's followers gain no reputation and less fame than usual for each faction unit they defeat (one less for *Green*, two less for *Brown*, three less for *Red*, but they still get the corresponding faction token reward). Magical glades or graveyards of a faction controlled by a player are never considered occupied (and thus, can no longer be liberated). At the beginning of a Round or when a player becomes a Faction Leader, a Player may assign any shield to each token in their faction with the following effects:

Shield of an opponent: The token is now pursuing that opponent

Shield of the owner: The token is now ambushing

Shield of the Volkare's Dummy deck: The token is now pursuing Volkare

If there are multiple Followers in the same hex, the stack is treated as one Follower for the purpose of assigning shields and resolving their actions as a Faction Leader. Volkare can provoke Followers or be attacked by pursuing Followers. When this happens, they are added to his army (see **Army Phase** below for how they behave in Volkare's army).

Stealing Faction Leadership

In PvP, a faction leader token may be stolen for 8 damage. When a player steals a Faction Leader token, all shields of both players involved in this PvP on followers of the Faction Leader associated with the Faction Leader token being stolen are swapped for the other player's shield (thus, all Followers that were ambushing would still be ambushing and followers that were previously pursuing the new Faction Leader pursue the previous Faction Leader). If a player is standing on top of one of their follower(s) and loses control of that monster token's faction, they may ignore these tokens for the first space of movement of their next turn (including ignoring pursuit). If they do not move on their next turn, forced retreat rules are applied.

Recruiting as a Faction Leader

If you are the leader of a faction, you can recruit followers of your faction. Elementalist enemy token followers can be recruited at the Elementalist stronghold or any magical glade in the *South* by the Faction Leader of the Elementalist. Dark Crusader enemy token followers can be recruited at the Dark Crusader stronghold or any graveyard in the *North* by the Faction Leader of the Dark Crusaders. A newly recruited follower can be placed anywhere on the board onto any one of the sites at which you could recruit followers of that faction that does not contain a player other than yourself (in co-operative play this last restriction is void). To do this, a player interacts at the site and pays 3 for each *Green*, 5 for each *Brown*, and 7 for each *Red* random follower that they wish to recruit. You can bring multiple followers into play but are limited to one per site per turn. You may place a shield on them immediately. As long as every faction enemy token of a certain color is on the board, no more enemy faction tokens of that color can be recruited (though if the initial pile of them runs out but there are some that have been discarded throughout the game, re-shuffle these and form a new stack). Note that this last rule overrides the usual Shades of Tezla rules for running out of faction enemy tokens.

At these same sites, a Faction Leader can also pay 4 influence for a faction token. You must place such a token in your inventory on your character's card. Unlike faction tokens gained in other ways, it cannot be used to gain fame or reputation. You can only store 3 faction tokens in your inventory, but may discard any number of them at any time for no effect (though you can still have any number from other sources).

Combat with Volkare

To fight Volkare, a player must move into his space, be in a space he moves into, or be attacked due to a red card he draws. If a player has a hand of all wounds, they cannot participate in combat with Volkare. If Volkare is in an unconquered city when attacked, treat the enemy tokens in Volkare's army as fortified, but ignore the city guards and do not lose reputation.

Army Phase

At the start of combat with Volkare, remove all of your followers from Volkare's army (in co-operative, instead remove all followers in his army) and place them in a separate pile called your *personal army*. We call the sum of the fame value of each of the followers in your personal army your *army strength*. Followers of opposing players remain in Volkare's army and are treated as any other enemy token (though rewards for destroying enemy followers is still as described in **Becoming a Faction Leader and Followers** above).

Enemy tokens in Volkare's army are then flipped one at a time at random (except for any single flip, for which the player may choose the color of the token to be flipped) from Volkare's army until an enemy is flipped such that the total fame of all flipped tokens would exceed your army strength. The last drawn enemy token (i.e. the one that causes the total fame to exceed your army strength) is then returned to Volkare's army and all other flipped enemy tokens are discarded. The followers in your personal army are then also discarded. You do not gain any fame or rewards for enemy tokens or followers discarded in this way.

Combined Assault on Volkare

Players can agree to a combined assault on Volkare, which initially works as in the normal rules. If all enemy tokens are defeated, the player who defeated the most fame worth of enemy tokens this combat wins the game (or everyone wins if playing cooperatively).

If any player(s) defeats their share of enemy tokens while other player(s) fail to, we call the set of players who defeat their share of enemy tokens *victorious* and those who had enemy tokens that went undefeated *distressed*. If all enemy tokens are not destroyed in a combined assault, the first victorious player in player order (starting from the player who initiated the combat) becomes the *prime victor*. The prime victor may pass, or choose any number of distressed players. If the prime victor passes, they are no longer considered victorious. If the prime victor chooses any non-zero number of distressed players, then they play an additional combat against Volkare.

In the additional combat, the prime victor first decides the level of attention they will pay to combat as if being attacked by Volkare. If they chooses to fully attend combat and their round order token is already face down, the player places a crystal next to their round order marker and will miss an additional turn for each (i.e. when it would next be their turn, if they have any crystals next to their round order token, they remove a crystal from next to their round order token and skip their turn instead of flipping their round order token face up and skipping their turn). The prime victor then fights all undefeated enemy tokens of the distressed player(s) they selected. This additional combat includes a new attack by Volkare himself as per the expansion rules (under **Volkare's Attack** in The Lost Legion rules). The selected distressed players are no longer considered distressed. If the prime victor defeated all of the enemy tokens in their additional combat, they remain victorious. If not, they become distressed.

No matter what the prime victor's choice or the additional combat outcome, the next victorious player in player order then becomes prime victor and repeats the process described above. This continues until either all enemy tokens have been defeated or no victorious players remain. Any crystals indicating a player should miss additional turns still present at the end of a round are discarded with no effect at the end of a round and a player's round order token is always placed face up at the start of a new round.

Defense from Volkare

If Volkare attacks a player, they can retreat to an adjacent space for a number of wounds equal to the round number divided by 2 plus 1 (rounded up). Otherwise, a player may partially or fully attend combat. If multiple players are attacked, they decide if they wish to fully or partially attend combat or retreat in reverse order from their round order token.

When multiple players are attacked in a city (after players decide if they will retreat or partially/fully attend combat), the city leader determines the order players will fight Volkare in if they are present. When multiple players are attacked outside of a city or inside a city when the city leader is not present, the players decide (in the order of the round order tokens) when they wish to fight Volkare in the combat order (example: 3 players attacked outside of a city all decide to fight. The player first in the round order can decide if they want to fight Volkare 1st, 2nd, or 3rd). When multiple players are attacked, regardless of location, they may choose to fight Volkare in a combined defense as opposed to individually. Larger groups count as having lower initiative than smaller groups for determining combat order, breaking group size ties by lowest combined initiative values of the group members and further breaking this tie by lowest initiative of the lowest initiative member of the groups (note that, if Volkare is moving onto a city occupied by a city leader who chooses to fight, the city leader will still choose the combat order of individuals and groups).

If the defending player(s) was attacked due to Volkare moving into a city he can be repealed. If Volkare loses at least one token, he is repealed and. In co-operative, Volkare must instead lose a number of tokens equal to or greater than the number of players during the combat to be repelled (though it does not matter which player(s) eliminate these tokens).

If Volkare is undefeated, players suffer forced retreat. In a city, if Volkare loses 3 or more enemy tokens (or 3 times the number of players in co-op) he is repelled, and must retreat to 2 spaces away from the city in a straight line in the direction from which he moved into the city. A player with a hand of all wounds that is attacked by Volkare must retreat and suffer the aforementioned retreat penalty.

Competitive Combat Levels

	Daring	Heroic	Legendary
Faction Avatar's Level	2	3	4
City Levels	4	6	8
Volkare's Level	10	14	18

Avatar Level Co-operative

	Daring	Heroic	Legendary
Solo	2	3	4
Two-Player	4	5	6
Three-Player	6	8	10
Four-Player	8	10	12
Five-Player	10	12	12+1*

*For a faction leader of level 12+x, treat the faction leader as having two separate sets of attacks, those at level 12 and those at level x. Combine the enemy tokens from level 12 and x. When the leader is marked with shield, mark them starting with level x and proceeding down to 12. As soon as the first x numbers are marked, clear the shields from the faction leader and treat the leader as per normal rules of level 12 faction leaders. At first, the armor of the leader is the highest unmarked level's armor among the first x. The armor of the leader is as normal once the faction leader has had shields cleared from the first x levels.

City Level Co-operative

	Daring	Heroic	Legendary
Solo	4	6	8
Two-Player	6	9	12
Three-Player	8	12	16
Four-Player	10	15	20
Five-Player	12	18	24

Volkare's Level Co-operative

	Daring	Heroic	Legendary
Solo	16	18	22
Two-Player	32	36	44
Three-Player	46	52	64
Four-Player	58	66	72
Five-Player	68	78	88

Race Level

Always 12 wounds and no indecisive units.

Comments on Competitive Difficulty Levels

Heroic: Players will be racing to beat an avatar first and hold on to their leader token to maintain leadership of a faction. They will then race back to fight Volkare before he is stolen by either the other faction leader or a particularly strong non-leader.

Daring: Players will be harder pressed to defeat avatars or to delay Volkare by taking a city, Volkare himself is stronger and thus, very difficult to defeat without being a faction leader. Players will have less time to devote to fighting amongst themselves and may even wish to resort to cooperative attacks to avoid everyone losing.

Legendary: Avatars and cities are now very difficult to defeat alone and players will be extremely hard pressed to defeat Volkare without cooperative action or being a faction leader. The time crunch of this scenario will almost assuredly force cooperative action, with players fighting one another only when Volkare is significantly weakened. The probability of all of the players losing is quite high.

REFERENCE

Graveyards/Necropolis: Graveyards now also remove wounds as if they were magical glades. Graveyards are only placed in the **North**.

When a North/South tile is revealed, roll for each rampaging monster and draw a monster of the appropriate color from the Non-Faction monster pile, or based upon the following criteria depending on the tile location and die roll:

- If on a **North** tile and black or red is rolled, draw instead from the Dark Crusader's monster pile.
- If on a **Far North** tile and black, red, white, or gold is rolled, draw instead from the Dark Crusader's monster pile.
- If on a **South** tile and gold or green is rolled, draw instead from the Elementalist's monster pile.
- If on a **Far South** tile and gold, green, blue, or black is rolled, draw instead from the Elementalist's monster pile.

Enemy Placement:

Graveyard (**North/Far North**) enemies on a countryside tile:

Green + **Brown** Dark Crusader

Graveyard (**North/Far North**) enemies on a core/city tile:

Brown + **Red** Dark Crusader

Magical Glade (**South/Far South**) enemies on a countryside tile:

Green + **Brown** Elementalist

Magical Glade (**South/Far South**) enemies on a core/city tile:

Brown + **Red** Elementalist

Night rules apply in a Graveyard and Necropolis, but none of the other effects of a Magical Glade, Hidden Valley, Graveyard or Necropolis can be used until they have been **Liberated**. Once liberated, they act as normal.

Liberation Rewards:

Countryside Tile **North**:

+1 Reputation + Spell + 2 Crystals of any colors.

Countryside Tile **South**:

+1 Reputation + Artifact.

Core/City Tile **North/South**:

+2 Reputation + Artifact + Spell + Advanced Action.

Liberated Faction Interaction:

3 Influence- **Green** Follower

5 Influence- **Brown** Follower

7 Influence- **Red** Follower

(One each per site per turn)

While you are the Leader of a Faction, you may interact in the Necropolis and Graveyards if Leader of the **North** or in the Hidden Valley and Magical Glades if Leader of the **South**.

Buying Faction Tokens with Influence

- 4 influence per faction token and placed in your inventory
- Maximum of 3 faction tokens in your Inventory
- You cannot use these faction tokens to gain Fame or Reputation
- You may discard any number of them at any time for no effect